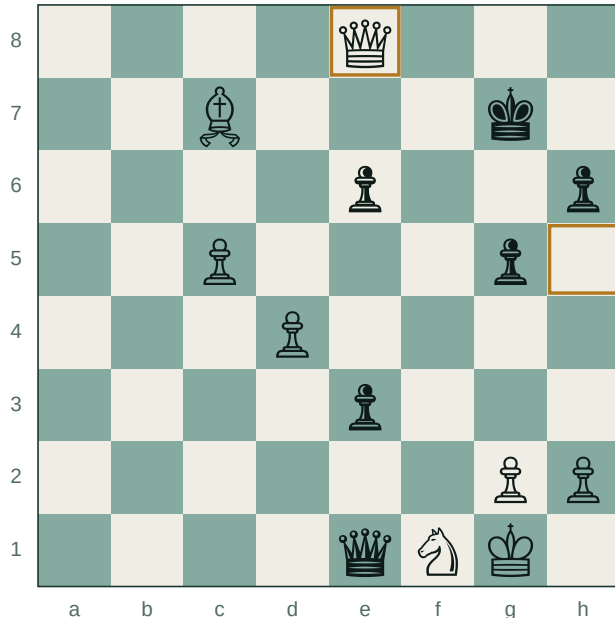


Deflection tactics: Black, move 34

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 34.Qe8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

34...Qf2+ 35. Kh1 Qxf1#

34...Qf2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From f2 it attacks king on g1 and knight on f1. Recorded reply: **35.Kh1**.

35...Qxf1# Mate: queen on f1 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on f1. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: knight on f1.